15445
5

REPORT

ON THE

ELURA CAVE TEMPLES

AND

THE BRAHMANICAL AND JAINA CAVES IN WESTERN INDIA

COMPLETING

THE RESULTS OF THE FIFTH, SIXTH, AND SEVENTH SEASONS' OPERATIONS OF THE ARCHÆOLOGICAL SURVEY

1877-78, 1878-79, 1879-80.

SUPPLEMENTARY TO THE VOLUME ON "THE CAVE TEMPLES OF INDIA."

1544

BY

JAS. BURGESS, LL.D., F.R.G.S.,
MEMBER OF THE ROYAL ASIATIC SOCIETY, OF THE SOCIÉTÉ ASIATIQUE, &c.
ARCHÆOLOGICAL SURVEYOR AND REPORTER TO GOVERNMENT
FOR WESTERN AND SOUTHERN INDIA.

913.012
BUR / W.I

1883

LONDON:
TRÜBNER & CO., LUDGATE HILL.
1883.

[*All rights reserved.*]

DEPT. OF ARCHAEOLOGY
LIBRARY
G.M.C. AURANGABAD.

PREFACE.

As the object of the present volume is sufficiently explained in the introductory chapter, very little need be added by way of preface to it. Like the preceding one, it is intended as a supplement to the volume on *The Cave Temples of India*, which was intended as a general *resumé* of the whole subject, but required for its completion special descriptions, such as those contained in this work on the Elura Caves, and on the Brahmanical and Jaina Caves elsewhere in Western India. These three volumes thus complete the description and illustration of the Cave Temples in Western India, so far as the Archæological Survey of the Bombay Presidency is at present concerned; and though they are far from exhausting the subject, they may be considered as giving a fair presentation of it. The illustrations of the art and mythology which these works contain, it is believed, will be found interesting and instructive by a numerous and varied class of cultivated and scientific readers.

The inscriptions from Kanheri Caves contained in this volume belong rather to the preceding one; but the first arrangements made for their translation having failed, they were delayed, and finally undertaken by Dr. G. Bühler, C.I.E., of Vienna, whose able versions will be valued by scholars. To him and to Mr. James Fergusson, D.C.L., LL.D., F.R.S., whose valuable help and suggestions have been most readily afforded me, I owe my most hearty thanks.

Materials have been partly collected for a full description of the Mediæval Temples of the Canarese Districts of the Bombay Presidency, especially those at Gadag, Lakshmêśvar, Lakkundi, Dambal, &c., which it is intended shall form the next volume of these reports; and that will probably be followed by another on the Architectural Remains in Gujarât and other districts in the northern parts of the Presidency.

JAS. BURGESS.

EDINBURGH, 14*th Oct.* 1882.

CONTENTS.

Chap.		Page
I.	Introductory—the Elurâ Caves	1
II.	The Buddhist Caves at Elurâ—the Southern Group	4
	Caves I–VI.	5
	Caves VII. and VIII.	7
	Cave IX.	8
III.	The Three Larger Buddhist Caves, or Northern Group	9
	The Viśvakarma Chaitya Cave, No. X.	9
	The Doṅ Ṭhâl Cave, No. XI.	13
	The Tîn Ṭhâl Cave, No. XII.	16
IV.	The Elurâ Brahmanical Cave Temples:—	
	The Dâs Avatâra	23
	The Kailâsa or Rang Mahâl	26
V.	Elurâ Brahmanical Caves North of Kailâsa:—	
	Caves XVII. to XX.	37
	Cave XXI.: Râmêśvara	38
	Caves XXII. to XXVII.	40
	Cave XXIX.: Dumar Lena	41
VI.	The Jaina Caves at Elurâ:—	
	The Indra Sabhâ	44
	The Jagannâth Sabhâ	48
	Cave XXXIV.	49
VII.	The Caves at Bâdâmi and Aihole	50
VIII.	Jôgêśvari or Amboli and Lonad Caves	52
	Lonâd	53
IX.	Elephanta Caves	55
X.	Hariśchandragaḍ and Pâtna Caves	57
	Patna Caves	57
XI.	Ankâi Caves—Brahmanical and Jaina	58
XII.	Inscriptions by Professor G. Bühler, C.I.E., Vienna:—	
	1. Nânâghâṭ Inscriptions	59
	2. Kaṇheri Inscriptions	74
	3. Dâśa Avatâra Inscription at Elurâ	87

DEPT. OF ARCHAEOLOGY. LIBRARY S.W.C. AURANGABAD.

LIST OF PLATES.

Plate		Page
I.	View of Kailasa Rock Temple at Elura from the North-West (Autotype Plate)	*Frontispiece.*
II.	General Plan of the Elurâ Caves and Plan of Caves XXIII., XXIV.	4
III.	Fig. 1, Section through the front of Viśvakarma Chaitya Cave; 2, Side View of the Dâgaba; 3, North Door of the Cave	9
IV.	Figs. 1–5, Windows in Kailâsa Hall; 6, Sculpture of Mahishamardinî on the wall; 7, Ditto in the front of the Court	28
V.	Front of the Râmêśvara Brahmanical Cave (Autotype)	38
VI.	The Indra Sabhâ Jaina Cave (Autotype)	44
VII.	Façade of the Caves on the West Side of the Indra Sabhâ Court (Autotype)	47
VIII.	Frieze in the Veranda of the Bâdâmi Brahmanical Cave No. II.	50
IX.	Roof of the Brahmanical Cave at Aihoḷe	51
X.	Door of the Shrine in the Brahmanical Cave of Jôgêśvari	53
XI.	The Trimurti and Arddhanâri Sculptures on the Back Wall of Elephanta (Autotype)	56
XII.	Ankâi Jaina Caves Nos. I. and II. (Autotype)	58

At the end—

XIII. Elurâ Buddhist Caves: Fig. 1, Pândarâ Târâ in Cave II.; 2, Târâ in Cave VI.; 3, Pilaster in Cave V.; 4, Sculpture on the right side of the shrine in Cave VI.; 5, Ditto on the left side; 6, Bodhisattva in Cave IX.

XIV. Elurâ: Plan of Bauddha Caves Nos. VII. and VIII.; 2, Tîn Ṭhâl, Plan of second storey.

XV. Elurâ: Plans of the three floors of the Dôn Thâl Cave.

XVI. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Transverse section of the Viśvakarma Cave; 2, Padmapâṇi in Cave IV.; 3, Sarasvatî in Cave VI.; 4, Pillar in Cave IX.; 5, Pillar in upper floor of the Dôn Ṭhâl Cave.

XVII. Details from the Viśvakarma Cave: 1, Sculpture on the inner side of the gallery; 2, Part of the Triforium; 3, Sculptures from the Dâgaba.

XVIII. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Inscription on the Viśvakarma Cave; 2, Pillar under the gallery in Viśvakarma; 3, Sculpture in the Tîn Ṭhâl Cave; 4, Buddha and attendants, from the Bâgh Caves.

XIX. Elurâ: Figs. 1, 2, Female heads from Viśvakarma Cave; 3, Head of Avalôkitêśvara from the same; 4, Vajrapâṇi, from the same; 5, Sculpture to the left of the shrine door in the upper storey of the Tîn Ṭhâl; 6, Panel in the Tîn Ṭhal.

XX. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Bodhisattvas on the right side of the shrine in the Tîn Ṭhâl; 2 and 3, Bodhisattvas from the Bâgh Caves.

XXI. Elurâ Brahmanical Caves: Fig. 1, Pillar in the Dâs Avatâra; 2, Shaft of Pilaster in ditto; 3, Śiva in the flaming Liṅga; 4, Śiva dancing the Tâṇḍava in the Dâs Avatâra.

XXII. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Narasiṁha and Hiraṇyakaśipu; 2, Bhairava, in the Dâs Avatara.

XXIII. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Transverse section of Kailâsa; 2, Section of the Dâs Avatâra Cave.

XXIV. Elurâ: Fig. 1, Śiva and Mârkandêya—from the Dâs Avâtara Cave; 2, The same from Kailâsa corridor.

XXV. Elurâ: Fig 1.

XXVI. Kailâsa: Fig. 1, Sculpture from the front of the Maṇḍapa; 2, Kâmadêva and Ratî, from the Court; 3, 4, Lions on the roof of the Maṇḍapa.

XXVII. Three Sculptures from the North corridor in the Court of Kailasa.

DEPT. OF ARCHAEOLOGY
LIBRARY
S.W.C. AURANGABAD.

REPORT

OF THE

ARCHÆOLOGICAL SURVEY OF WESTERN INDIA.

THE ELURA CAVES

AND

OTHER BRAHMANICAL AND JAINA CAVE TEMPLES.

CHAPTER I.

INTRODUCTORY: THE ELURÂ CAVES.

IN the preceding volume the description of the more notable groups of Buddhist Rock Temples, as given in the work on *The Cave Temples of India*, was considerably amplified by additional details and numerous illustrations, which will enable the architect and student to form a tolerably accurate idea of the style and character of the plans and ornamentation, as well as of the sculptures of these ancient and interesting works. And in addition to these, the facsimiles and translations of the inscriptions will afford fresh materials of a trustworthy character for the epigraphist and philologist, with a certain amount of important information of historical importance. But even that volume by no means exhausts the illustrations that might have been given, especially from Ajaṇṭâ, of the artistic decorative work on columns, doors, windows, and friezes, or of the extensive mythological sculptures found in such rich abundance there and at Kaṇheri.

The intention of the present volume is to apply the same process to the illustration of the remaining Rock Temples of Western India. The principal of these are—the whole of the well-known and magnificent group at Elurâ, consisting of splendid representatives of the three classes—Bauddha, Brahmanical, and Jaina Cave Temples; the Brahmanical and Jaina Caves at Bâdâmi, at Aihoḷe, at Ankâi Tankâi, and at Pâtna; and the Brahmanical Caves, chiefly at Jôgêśwari on Salsette Island, at Lonaḍ, and at Hariśchandragaḍ. To give anything like a complete illustration of these Cave Temples, or even of those at Elurâ alone, however, would occupy double the number of plates that can be given in this volume; but with those in *The Cave Temples*, as here supplemented, the reader may form some adequate conception of the characteristics of the different groups, and of the variety of architectural and mythological sculpture that is presented in these early monuments of the religious

1544

faiths of India. ("All commentary," remarks M. Baudrillart,[1] "grows pale before the magnificent ruins of the temples of Elurâ, which, more than any other ruins, confuse the human imagination. At the sight of these astounding edifices . . . the development of the plastic arts and of public religious luxury amongst the Hindus receives the most striking attestation in the magnificence of these temples, in the infinite diversity of their details, and the minute variety of the carvings.")

In this volume it seems preferable to treat the Elurâ Caves as a whole, and to illustrate the temples found there—Buddhist, Brahmanical, and Jaina—as a series complete in itself. In *The Cave Temples*, three separate chapters were devoted to the three sections of this group,[2] illustrated by about thirty-one plates, and to each section was assigned its relative place among the other excavations of the same character. In the supplementary information to be now given such a distribution is no longer required, as it is only proposed to amplify the illustration of the Elurâ Caves, as given in the former work, in their topographical order from south to north—which, as it happens, is also that of their religious character, and pretty nearly of their relative ages. This is the arrangement adopted by Dr. James Fergusson in his *Rock-Cut Temples of India*, who was the first to point out the religious characteristics of the different groups, which this mode of describing them brought to light.

It is only thus by treating of the Elurâ group as a whole that an adequate idea can be obtained of this series of cave temples, which is probably the most magnificent and most interesting in India. The only other group that can rival it in interest is that at Ajaṇṭâ. There, however, the caves all belong to one religion, and beginning at a very much earlier period than anything found at Elurâ, carry on the history of the Buddhist religion and architecture for nearly 1000 years; and though the series at Elurâ commenced nearly at the time when the excavations at Ajaṇṭâ ceased, an immense additional interest was added there by the introduction of temples of a novel form belonging to the Hindu religion, and subsequently by others of the Jaina faith, affording a varied picture of the mythology of India during the period of its greatest vigour, such as is nowhere else to be found. Moreover, besides the interest attaching to the individual members of the group, which in themselves are probably equal to any found elsewhere, the whole culminates worthily in the Kailâsa, which is certainly the most magnificent rock-cut temple in India, and by itself is sufficient to give a dignity and importance to this group beyond any other series of rock-cut temples which India possesses.

At Ajaṇṭâ one feels that there is a homogeneity in the mythology represented in the painting and sculpture throughout the whole range of the caves; they are all manifestly the work of one sect as it developed its art and its mythology. At Kaṇheri, also, we have the same thing; but while at Ajaṇṭâ the art rapidly develops in richness, at Kaṇheri the architecture is, from the earliest to the latest example, exceedingly plain and unadorned; by the style or order of the pillars and the arrangements of the caves, however, we readily see that they are spread over a long period of time, and the mythological figures mark the progress of the school of the Greater Vehicle, but there is no such marked advance in decorative sculpture as we find at Ajaṇṭâ. The two groups differ in the same manner as

---

[1] *Histoire du Luxe, Privé et Public, depuis l'Antiquité jusqu'à nos Jours.*

[2] See *Cave Temples*, Bk. II., chap. iv, pp. 367–384, and plates lvii to lxv for the Bauddha Caves; Bk. III., chap. v, pp. 431–463, and plates lxx to lxxxiv for the Brahmanical Caves; and Bk. IV., chap. iii, pp. 495–502, and plates lxxxvi to xcii for the Jaina Caves.

the quarter of a royal city containing the palaces of the king and his nobles does from the suburbs of the working-classes.

The Elurâ Buddhist Caves on the other hand differ in many respects from both these groups; they are on quite as large a scale as any at Ajaṇṭâ, but differ in their arrangements, and though they contain abundance of sculpture, it varies markedly both in its subjects and in details from that at Ajaṇṭâ, while the ornamentation is much less elaborate. They differ also from the Kaṇheri group in their vastly larger dimensions, their plans, and in the greater amount both of sculptured ornamentation and mythology, but especially in the character of the latter. Thus, while the dâgoba is a frequent object of representation in the bas-reliefs at Kaṇheri, it only occurs once or twice at Elurâ, and then in very small examples, and in positions by no means prominent. Nâga-hooded figures, so often represented both in the sculptures and paintings at Ajaṇṭâ, as well as at Amarâvati, Bôrô Bûdûr, Sânchî, and Bharhut, are not found here; and while both at Kaṇheri and Ajaṇṭâ the Buddha is represented without any supporters or only with two, at Elurâ he is most frequently attended by six, eight, or ten of the Bodhisattvas, whilst *śaktis* or *dêvîs*—later additions to the Bauddha pantheon—figure much more frequently and prominently on the walls of these caves than they do at either of the two groups just named. When we compare them again with the sculptures on the *stûpas* at Sânchi, Bharhut, Amarâvati, and Bôrô Bûdûr,[1] we note still further differences, and are led to consider whether these variations may not be very largely due to the difference of sects or schools into which the Buddhists were very early divided, and whether each of the greater schools—which were probably to a large extent practically local—may not have developed much that was special to itself in its mythology or the modes of representing the beings in the pantheon. This would help to account for differences in the characteristics of the sculptures at Amarâvatî, Kaṇheri, Elurâ, Ajaṇṭâ, and Sânchî. True, much of this variety is due to differences of age; and the lack of sculpture in the Junṇar, Nâsik, and other caves, is doubtless to some extent owing to their early age; but the recent discovery of an inscription of Vasishṭhîputra Puḷumâvi at Amarâvatî, shows that the difference between the sculptures there and at Nâsik and Kârlê, where other inscriptions of the same king are found, is due to other causes, such as we have just indicated, quite as much as to difference of age. Moreover, we learn from I-tsing, a writer of the end of the seventh century, that the Sarvâstivâdin schools were less honoured in the Marâṭha country than in Magadha, but that the Sammatîyas were particularly respected. In the south the Mahâsthavira school was universally honoured; and in Eastern India each of the four schools (Mahâsaṅghika, Âryasthavira, Sarvâstivâdin, and Sammatîya) had its adherents in different districts.[2] It seems, moreover, to be more than a mere surmise that the varieties in sculptures are largely owing to the various schools that constructed different stûpas or excavated special groups of caves, for, on comparing the sculptures in these Eḷurâ Caves with the mythology of the Yogâchârya school of the Mahâyâna, founded by Âryâsaṅga,[3] we find the agreement so marked that we may conclude they were the works

[1] See the magnificent illustrations of Bôrô Bûdûr, published by order of H. E. the Minister of the Dutch Colonies (Leide, 1874).

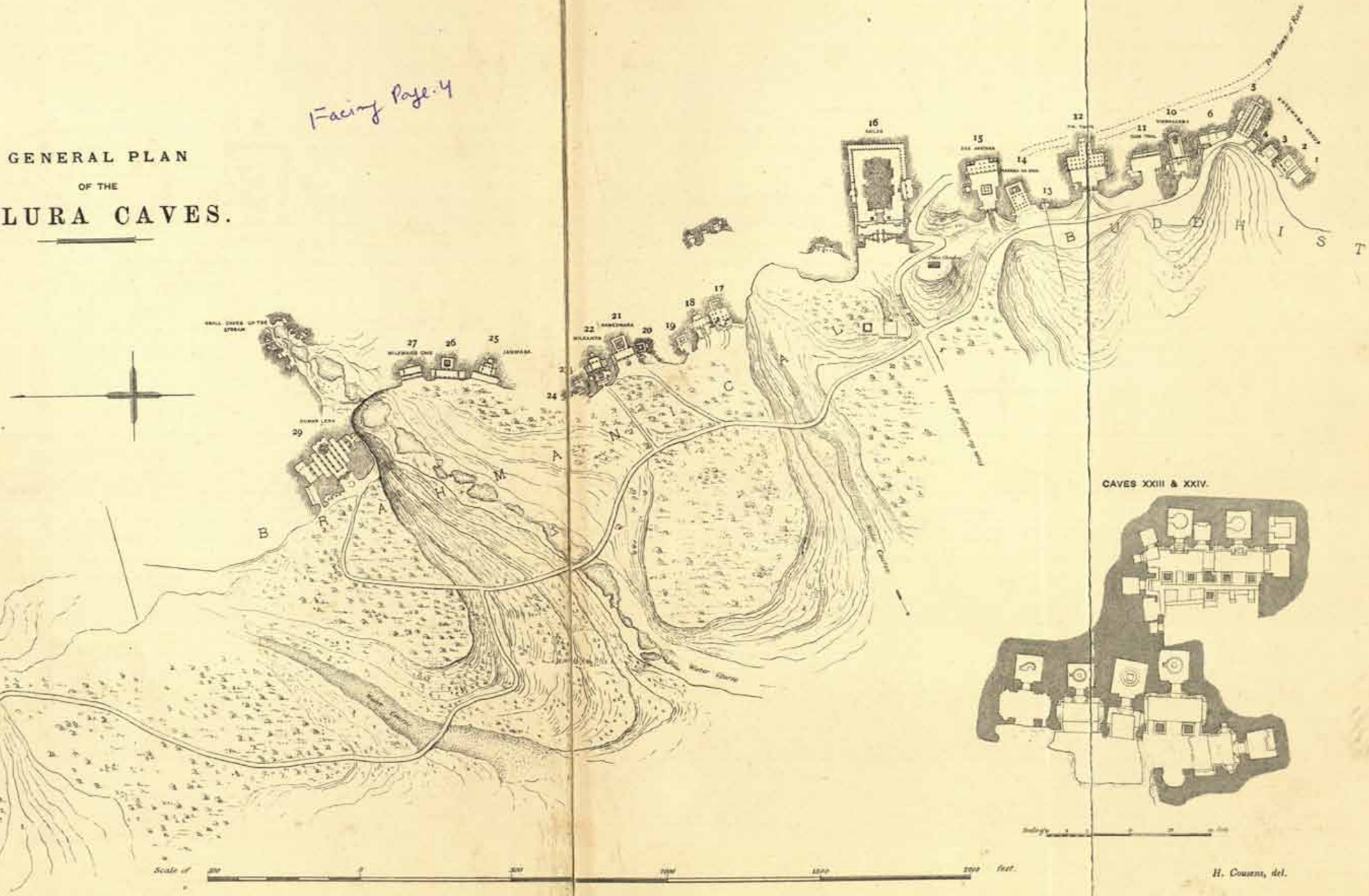
[2] Beal's *Buddhist Literature in China*, p. 65. The Sammatîyas were followers of the Hînayâna, and were split into three schools. Most of the early schools were, however, afterwards more or less influenced by the doctrines of Nâgârjuna and Asaṅga.

[3] He is said by Târânâtha to have lived 900 years after Buddha, and by others 100 years after Nâgârjuna: perhaps early in the fourth century, Vassilief, *Bouddh.*, pp. 31, 52, 65; St. Julien's *Mém. des Cont. Occid.*, tome i, pp. 105, 269.

DEPT. OF ARCHAEOLOGY S.W.C. LIBRARY AURANGABAD

Facing Page 4

GENERAL PLAN OF THE ELURA CAVES.



J. Burgess.

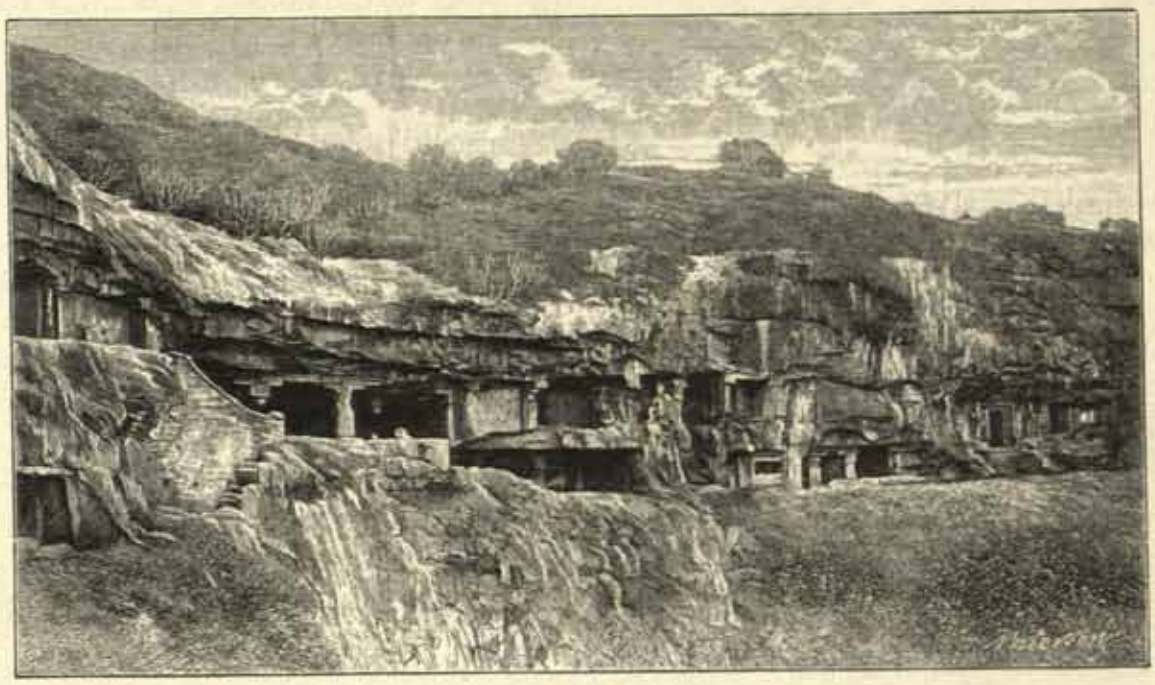
CAVES XXIII & XXIV.

H. Cousens, del.

hârwâḍâ—are on a considerably larger scale and more magnificent in their arrangements, but they seem to have been pushed in at a higher level than the adjoining Caves I., III., and VII., and were probably contemporary with the great Chaitya Cave—the Viśvakarma—which with two or three others was probably excavated during the seventh century A.D. Nos. VIII., IX., and XI. were probably even later than this, and may be considered as marking the expiring efforts of the Buddhists in Western India.

Caves Nos. I.–VI.

The first six caves have been described in some detail in *The Cave Temples* (pp. 368-375, and plates lvii to lxi). The accompanying woodcut (No. 1) presents a view of Caves



No. 1.—The Southern Bauddha Caves at Elurâ, from a photograph.

Nos. II. to V. Cave I. is hidden by the mass of debris in front of it, but it is just under the right side of Cave II., of which the door and large window to the right of it are seen near the right-hand side of the view. Cave III. is at a lower level to the left. Cave V., with the fragments of a large chapel belonging to it on the south side (of which the whole west half has fallen away), extends from over the left side of Cave III. to behind a parapet wall recently erected to afford a safe passage along the face of the scarp. The interior of Cave IV., which is very much ruined, is seen under the chapel of Cave V.

Sculptured in a large panel on the inside of the front wall of Cave No. II. is the figure represented in fig. 1 of plate xiii, where we have either Pândarâ the mother of Padmapâṇi or some other of the Târâs. Both her two attendants have flowers in their hands; and here, though somewhat abraded by time, are six *Vidyâdharas* or cherubs over the head of the goddess. In her right hand she probably held up a *mâlâ* or rosary, but it is now obliterated. Behind the head is the aureole or *bhâmaṇḍala*, which indicates that she is a celestial personage; and in her ears are large earrings of different forms. On the front of the *mukuṭa* or headdress is a dâgaba, which must be taken as her *chinha* or cognisance; and as it is also associated with Akshôbhya, the second Jñâni Buddha, we may